News Release
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S&P Global US Manufacturing PMI®

PMI hits highest level since May 2022 as firms lift output markedly on the back of surging new orders

September 2026

Production and new orders both increase as domestic demand strengthens

Workforce numbers expanded to greatest degree in over five years

Supply chain challenges persist, contributing to further uplift in cost inflation

Growth of the US manufacturing sector lifted higher in September as a notable increase in new orders encouraged firms to raise production and expand employment.

Factory capacity nonetheless remained under pressure, whilst supply chains were again stretched with lead times for the delivery of inputs lengthening to the greatest degree for over four years.

Export orders also declined due to tariffs, whilst input prices rose at a steeper rate due to not only tariffs, but also high energy prices and the short supply of key items like steel and electronics. Firms continued to signal efforts to build stock in the face of price and supply-chain concerns.

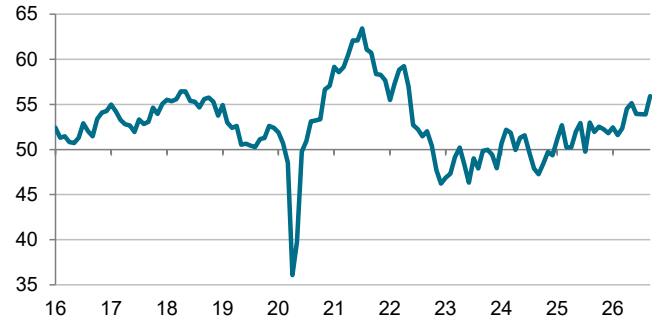
The seasonally adjusted S&P Global US Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index™ (PMI®) surged higher in September, posting 55.9, up from 53.9 in August. Recording well above the critical 50.0 no-change mark, the latest reading was the strongest since May 2022. Growth has now been registered every month since August 2025.

All five PMI components supported the uplift in the headline index. Most notably, output and new orders registered faster rates of growth. Panelists commented on a broad-based uplift in demand, with government and tech-related industries mentioned as sources of higher sales, with latest data indicating the best rise in sales since April 2026 and the second-strongest since May 2022. Firms responded by increasing their production sharply to extend the current run of output growth to 16 months.

Once again, it was the domestic market that underpinned demand growth as new export orders fell for the fifteenth successive month. Panelists reported that tariffs and elevated shipping costs had dampened international sales.

Strong growth in overall sales and production encouraged companies to take on additional staff in September. The net increase in jobs was the highest in over five years as firms scrambled to expand capacity and deal with the influx of new work and existing workloads. However, there were several reports of difficulties in securing suitable labor, and this was

S&P Global US Manufacturing PMI
Index, sa, >50 = improvement m/m



Data were collected 10-25 September 2026.
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Comment

Chris Williamson, Chief Business Economist at S&P Global Market Intelligence:

"September has seen the pace of US manufacturing growth pick up a gear again, the PMI lifting to its highest since May 2022 as a surge in new orders encouraged factories to lift output sharply higher and take on workers in increasing numbers.

"Order book backlogs are rising and suppliers are increasingly busy, pointing to stretched capacity as companies struggle to meet demand across both consumer-facing and business sectors. This is most notable in the investment and production of machinery and equipment, linked in many cases to rising AI-related spend. Safety stock building amid price and supply chain worries also continues to support demand, though the ongoing loss of export orders remains a disappointment.

"While sending an encouraging signal for further growth of manufacturing capacity in the coming months, the indication that demand is outstripping supply also means inflationary pressures remain a key area of concern, especially amid high oil prices.

"The combination of accelerating growth, increased hiring and elevated price gauges will add to speculation of a further imminent rate hike from the FOMC."

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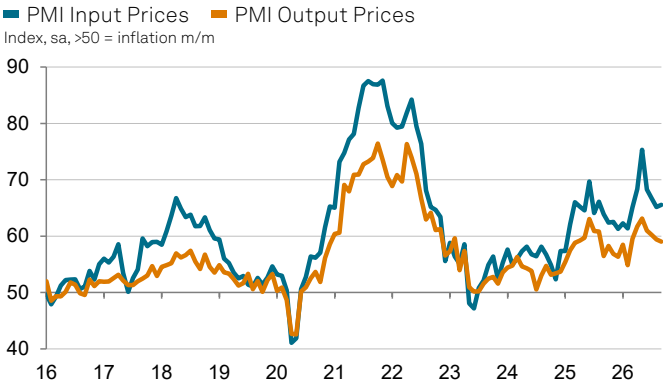
a factor that led to another rise in work outstanding. Overall, backlogs of unfinished orders rose for a seventh successive month and to the greatest degree since April.

Manufacturers also reported that input delivery delays had contributed to backlog growth. Indeed, latest data showed typical vendor lead times lengthening to the greatest degree since August 2022. There were reports of widespread stock shortages at suppliers, with a swathe of products reportedly hard to source, especially steel and electronics-related items. Shipping challenges across global maritime routes, plus customs delays (especially at the Canadian border) added to supply-side pressure.

The short supply of inputs, tariffs and the war in Iran all served to push up manufacturing input costs at a faster rate than in August. Alongside metals and electronics, firms widely reported increased energy and fuel prices. In response, manufacturers raised their own charges steeply albeit to the weakest degree since February.

Despite rising inflationary pressures, and ongoing supply-side challenges, manufacturers are confident the recent upswings in production and new orders can be sustained. Indeed, confidence in the outlook remained positive (albeit a little below its historical trend), with firms linking their optimism to positive order book pipelines, and expectations for market, product and commercial expansion. Some firms also hope for greater stability in the business environment and a drop in energy prices.

Reflective of positive production and sales forecasts, companies sought to build inventories of inputs and finished goods. Purchasing activity rose markedly, expanding at an above-trend pace that was the fastest since June. Despite supply-side delays, and a strong uplift in production needs, the rise in purchasing activity helped to drive stocks of purchases higher for the sixth successive month.



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Contact

Chris Williamson
Chief Business Economist
S&P Global Market Intelligence
T: +44-20-7260-2329
chris.williamson@spglobal.com

Usamah Bhatti
Economist
S&P Global Market Intelligence
T: +44-1344-328-370
usamah.bhatti@spglobal.com

Florence Bogitsh
Senior Communications Manager, Americas
S&P Global Market Intelligence
T: +1-646-460-7204
florence.bogitsh@spglobal.com
press.mi@spglobal.com

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Methodology

The S&P Global US Manufacturing PMI® is compiled by S&P Global from responses to questionnaires sent to purchasing managers in a panel of around 600 manufacturers. The panel is stratified by detailed sector and company workforce size, based on contributions to GDP. Data collection began in May 2007.

Survey responses are collected in the second half of each month and indicate the direction of change compared to the previous month. A diffusion index is calculated for each survey variable. The index is the sum of the percentage of 'higher' responses and half the percentage of 'unchanged' responses. The indices vary between 0 and 100, with a reading above 50 indicating an overall increase compared to the previous month, and below 50 an overall decrease. The indices are then seasonally adjusted.

The headline figure is the Purchasing Managers' Index™ (PMI). The PMI is a weighted average of the following five indices: New Orders (30%), Output (25%), Employment (20%), Suppliers' Delivery Times (15%) and Stocks of Purchases (10%). For the PMI calculation the Suppliers' Delivery Times Index is inverted so that it moves in a comparable direction to the other indices.

Underlying survey data are not revised after publication, but seasonal adjustment factors may be revised from time to time as appropriate which will affect the seasonally adjusted data series.

For further information on the PMI survey methodology, please contact economics@spglobal.com.

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